

EX-RED CITES ROLE OF 12 CONGRESSMEN

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WASHINGTON, Dec. 8 (UP)—

An admitted former Communist testified today that twelve Congressmen "initiated" a coalition of organizations in 1948 that the Communist party took over that same year under the name of the Civil Rights Congress.

Leonard Goldsmith of Louisville, the former Communist, did not name the Congressmen or explain their roles. He said the coalition helped to block the Mundt-Nixon anti-Communist bill of 1948.

Mr. Goldsmith testified at a hearing before a subversive activities control board. The hear-

ing was called on a Justice Department request that the Civil Rights Congress be required to register as a Communist-front organization.

He revealed that he had been the 1948 director of the original coalition group, the Committee for Democratic Rights, which he said was composed of several hundred organizations, including the Communist party. Later, Mr. Goldsmith told reporters that the committee had "had no Communist taint" until it was taken over by the Civil Rights Congress.

After the Mundt-Nixon bill was blocked, Mr. Goldsmith said, he was approached by Communist leaders, including Eugene Dennis and Elizabeth Gurley Flynn, who have been convicted under the

Smith Act for advocating overthrow of the Government.

He said they proposed merging the committee into an organization to be called the Civil Rights Congress. The merger was agreed on at Philadelphia in July, 1948, he added.